British Consulate for Taiwan,
Takow, 12 June 1874

No. 12.

My Lord,

In continuation of my despatch No. 10 of the 31st ultimo, I have the honour to enclose copy of my despatch to Her Majesty's Minister at Peking, No. 9 of to-day's date, concerning

The Right Honourable
Lord Tenterden
&c &c &c
Foreign Office
London

The National Archives' reference FO 17/686

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Concerning the Japanese
expedition to Formosa.

I have the honour to be,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's most obedient
humble servant,
Mulgregory

Consul Pickering

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British Consulate for Taiwan,
Takow, 12th June 1874.

Sir,

In continuation of my No 8 of the 27th ultimo, I add the following items concerning the Japanese Expedition.

The Japanese Consul, mentioned in my last letter, called upon me here on the 27th ultimo, and proved to be a Major Tkushima, whom I had previously met here and at Lang-kiaow. He had exchanged visits with the Mandarins at Taiwanfoo, with the appearance of friendship. I did not hear what business

T. F. Wade Esq C.B.
H. B. M. Envoy Extraordinary,
&c &c &c
Peking.

Mr. Gregory
No. 12

one inclosure

Rec'd Aug. 11.

Re Japanese expedition,
Continued.

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business had passed.

On the 3rd and 4th Instant, the Chinese steamer "Fuh-sing", with some small Mandarins and a European gentleman from the Customs on board, visited Lang-kiaou. On the 4th, H. M. S. "Hornet" arrived from Langkiaou. On the 6th, H. M.'s Corvette "Thalia", Captain H. B. Woollcombe, arrived from Hong Kong, having called at Lang-kiaou; (She was going on to Northern Formosa and to join the Admiral at Japan.) There was not much news from Lang-kiaou by these vessels. The wet and rough weather would have checked — operations. Lang-kiaou had shown itself

itself to be, (as was suspected), a bad anchorage for summer:- there had been a heavy swell in the Bay, the sea breaking where the "Hornet" was lying; and the "Hornet" had put out to sea for a time. The U. S. Steamer "Monocacy" had been at Langkiaou. There was only one Japanese vessel there at the time of the "Thalia"'s visit.

H. M. S. "Dwarf" arrived to take the "Hornet's" place, and went down to Lang kiaou on the 8th.

The Chinese steamer "Chang-shing" went down yesterday, and returned to day, passing up to Taiwanfoo.

Since the 8th Instant there have been repeated reports (through Chinese) of successes on the part of

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of the Japanese. Several savage villages, including Mow-tan or Baw-tan, had been taken. The savages of other villages had fled in anticipation, or had given in their submission. By

By a report received to-day there was (yester-day or this morning) a Japanese steamer ~~on~~ landing stores at Lang-kiaou. Another was at anchor at How-wan, below Lang-kiaou; another had gone to operate on the East Coast or South end of the island. The Koo-a-luts, (who were heard of in 1867 in regard to the "Rover" case), are said to have given in their submission to the Japanese. On the other hand,

Some

some of the Japanese stationed at Baw-tan had been stealthily killed or wounded.

As regards the Chinese, an additional force arrived in Formosa from the mainland in March last, to assist in putting down some disturbance in the Changhwa District, which has been done. I hear lately of troops being moved to the South, but not into the savages' country. There are various rumours about Mandarins expected to come from the main-land. I hope

soon

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soon to visit Pe-tow and — Tawanfoo; and may learn — something more authentic.

I have received a despatch from the Hackwan in regard to the Japanese busineſs, of which I will send copy in No. 10 of to-day's date.

This letter goes per H.M.S. "Hornet", which is leaving Takow for Amoy.

Your obedient Servant

(Signed) W. Gregory

Consul Officiating

True Copy

W. Gregory

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British Consulate for Taiwan,
Takow, 24 June 1874.

No 13.

My Lord,

In continuation of my despatch No. 5 of the 7th March, I have the honour to send my remaining Returns of Trade (Nos. 4 and 5), and Trade Report, for the year

The Right Honourable
Lord Tenterden,
&c &c &c
Foreign Office,
London.

Mr Swinhoe
The Japanese Expedition

Enclosure
in Mr Gregory's
No 12.
of 12th June 1874.

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